



Diseases Named After People

It's weird how hearing a scientist's name could mean bad news for patients. Here's a list of eponymous diseases. <http://digit.in/jan21-93>



Food Named After People

Age-old chefs used to name their dishes after famous people. Check out some of those delicacies! <http://digit.in/jan21-94>



Philip's screw named after Henry Frank Phillips

The Robertson screw with the square drive head is considered the first fastener suitable for use in industrial production lines, and over 700 were used in a single Model T Ford. In the 1932 John P Thompson invented and patented the self centering, cross driven screw (#1,908,080), but was initially unable to find buyers for his invention. He sold the invention to Oregon based businessman Henry Frank Phillips, who made improvements to the design, established the Phillips Screw Company and the rest is history. One of Phillips' earliest customers was General Motors, who used the screws on their Cadillac assembly lines.



The sandwich named after John Montagu, 4th earl of Sandwich

This one may be a bit of an Urban Legend, but food historians agree with the essentials of the story. John Montagu, the 4th Earl of Sandwich, was somewhat of an obsessive gambler, and would spend hours at the gambling table. During one of these sessions in 1762, he asked his cook to send him whatever could be eaten at the table without requiring a plate. His unnamed cook was then the person who "invented" the sandwich, by sending the Earl some meat wrapped in bread. The dish quickly became popular in England, and then the rest of the world.



Tupperware named after Earl Tupper

Earl Silas Tupper developed and patented the airtight and watertight plastic containers with what was then known as the "burping lid" in 1938 itself, at the age of 19. It was not until 1946 that Tupper was able to use direct marketing to start selling more of the plastic containers to households across the US. The primary customers were working women and house wives, and the selling of the products allowed women to be independent and have a source of income. Tupperware parties became the rage across America in the 1950s, laying a foundation for a business model that continues to end friendships even today!



Credit: Smithsonian



Vernier calipers named after Pierre Vernier

Callipers without scales were in use since ancient times, and originated in China. In 1631, the French mathematician Pierre Vernier added the secondary scales to the calipers, which made them far more accurate. The device was described in a treatise written by Vernier called "La construction, l'usage, et les propriétés du quadrant nouveau de mathématique". Over the years the essential design for this incredibly accurate instrument has been more or less the same, though there have been elaborate analogue indicators to provide the readings. The latest models have digital readouts.

